

EDU-FOOT: South African Diabetic Foot Prevention & Limb Preservation Training Programme

A Public-Private Partnership Proposal for Corporate Collaboration, Facilitation & Funding

1. Executive Summary

EDU-FOOT is a scalable, podiatry-led, multidisciplinary training programme designed to equip South African public sector nurses and allied health workers with the skills to prevent diabetic foot ulcers (DFUs) and reduce preventable amputations. Developed by **Mazizi Njokweni**, Senior Podiatrist at Leratong Hospital, this programme integrates evidence-based protocols from the proposed **Amputation Prevention Protocol (APP)** and Gauteng's **Limb Salvage Programme**, contextualised for resource-limited settings.

We invite **pharmaceutical, wound care, and diabetic care companies** to collaborate as strategic partners in funding, resource provision, and programme facilitation. Your support will directly contribute to:

- **Training 500+ nurses annually** in diabetic foot screening, wound care, and referral.
- **Reducing amputations by up to 50%** in pilot facilities within 2–3 years.
- **Building a replicable national model** for diabetic foot care in South Africa.

2. The Problem: Why EDU-FOOT Is Urgently Needed

Local Data from Leratong Hospital & Gauteng (Manuscript Insights):

- **84% of amputations** are preceded by diabetic foot infections.

- **96% of patients** admitted with diabetic foot sepsis undergo amputation.
- **>70% of first amputations** are major (above ankle).
- **Only 12% of primary care clinics** have monofilaments for neuropathy screening.
- **<0.5 podiatrists per 100,000 population** in Gauteng's public sector.
- **73% of neuropathy cases are missed** due to lack of screening tools and training.

Broader Impact:

- Post-amputation mortality: **~19% within 4 years**.
- Treatment costs can consume **5+ years of household income** for low-income families.
- Systemic gaps in screening, referral, and multidisciplinary coordination perpetuate poor outcomes.

3. Programme Overview: EDU-FOOT Structure

EDU-FOOT is a **modular, competency-based training programme** delivered through:

A. Core Training Tracks:

1. **Foundation Course (1 day):** Risk stratification, foot exam, basic wound care.
2. **Advanced Wound Care Module (2 days):** Infection control, offloading, dressing selection.
3. **Train-the-Trainer (3 days):** For "EDU-FOOT Champions" to sustain training locally.

B. Key Curriculum Elements:

- **Risk stratification** using adapted WIFI/PEDIS systems.

- **Hands-on skills:** Monofilament use, pulse palpation, bedside Doppler, wound staging.
- **Patient education & communication** for low-literacy populations.
- **Referral pathway integration** using the **APP algorithm**.
- **Digital tools:** Mobile apps, telemedicine support, e-registry.

C. Delivery Model:

- **Blended learning:** In-person workshops + virtual mentorship.
- **Mobile training units** for rural/underserved clinics.
- **Ongoing support:** WhatsApp groups, quarterly webinars, peer networks.

4. Alignment with Existing Frameworks

EDU-FOOT is not standalone—it integrates into:

- **Leratong Hospital's APP:** Podiatry-led triage, infection/ischaemia pathways.
- **Gauteng Limb Salvage Programme:** Four-pillar model (screening, hotline, wound clinic, remission).
- **National Department of Health Priorities:** Integrated Chronic Disease Management (ICDM).

5. Partnership Opportunity: How Your Company Can Engage

We propose **three tiers of corporate partnership**:

Tier 1: Platinum Partner (Comprehensive Support)

- **Funding:** R 500,000+ per annum.

- **Resource provision:** Wound care kits, monofilaments, Doppler devices, training manuals.
- **Co-branding:** Logo on all EDU-FOOT materials, recognition as founding partner.
- **Facilitation:** Company experts as guest trainers (wound care, infection control).

Tier 2: Gold Partner (Programme Facilitator)

- **Funding:** R 250,000–500,000 per annum.
- **In-kind support:** Donated wound care products, educational materials.
- **Participation:** Involvement in annual symposium, case study development.

Tier 3: Silver Partner (Training Sponsor)

- **Funding:** R 100,000–250,000 per annum.
- **Sponsored elements:** Specific training modules, mobile app development, nurse scholarships.

6. Benefits to Corporate Partners

- **Brand alignment** with a high-impact, scalable public health initiative.
- **CSR/Sustainability reporting** with measurable outcomes.
- **Market insights** into public sector wound care needs in South Africa.
- **Professional engagement** for your clinical teams through training facilitation.
- **Media & recognition** via provincial DOH channels, academic publications, and conference presentations.

7. Measurable Outcomes & Evaluation

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):

- Number of nurses trained (target: 500 in Year 1).

- % increase in foot screening compliance in pilot clinics.
- Reduction in late-presenting DFUs.
- Improvement in appropriate referral rates.
- Patient satisfaction and retention in foot care programmes.

Reporting:

- Quarterly impact reports to partners.
- Annual symposium with partners, DoH, and trainees.
- Co-authored publications in peer-reviewed journals.

8. Budget Overview (Year 1)

(We plan to train 10 to 20 nurses per quarter, to reach a minimum goal of 80 nurses annually).

9. Why Partner With Us?

- **Led by experienced podiatrists** with frontline hospital experience.
- **Embedded within public health system** for sustainability and scale.
- **Evidence-based design** informed by local data and international best practice.
- **Clear pathways to impact** with robust monitoring frameworks.
- **Aligned with national and provincial health priorities.**

10. Next Steps & Call to Action

We invite your company to join us in transforming diabetic foot care in South Africa. To explore this partnership:

1. **Schedule a meeting** with Mazizi Njokweni and the EDU-FOOT team.
2. **Review the full programme blueprint** and co-design partnership details.

3. **Sign a Memorandum of Understanding** to formalise collaboration.

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EDU-FOOT: Every Diabetic Ulcer Footcare-Oriented Outcome Training

Step Ahead of Amputation.